letter that she had originally tried to have published in the *Boston Herald*. It spoke about aerial spraying of a mixture of fuel oil and a chemical compound named DDT (dichloro-diphenyl-trichloroethane), in the vicinity of her small bird sanctuary in Michigan. The morning after the spraying, Huckins found several birds dead on her property and hoped that Carson might know someone in Washington who could stop further spraying. Carson was outraged and resolved to help. For more than a decade she had been aware of troubling incidents in which indiscriminate spraying of DDT had been killing wildlife. Carson swiftly approached the editor of the *New Yorker*, E.B. White, suggesting that the magazine run a piece about the growing concern around synthetic pesticides and their effect on nontarget organisms. The editor suggested that she write the article herself. Reluctantly, Carson began research on what she at first called “the poison book.” It went on to shake the world.